

MICROSOFT EXCEL

Professional Shortcut Keys & Quick Reference Guide

A practical, categorized reference covering everyday navigation, data entry, formatting, formulas, tables, filters, PivotTables, charts, worksheets, printing, Ribbon commands and productivity shortcuts.

Best for: Office work • Data entry • Reporting • Finance • Analysis • MIS • Daily Excel productivity

Quick tip: Learn the shortcuts in Sections 1–7 first. They cover most daily Excel work.

1. Essential Everyday Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + N	New workbook
Ctrl + O	Open workbook
Ctrl + S	Save workbook
F12	Save As
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + W	Close workbook
Alt + F4	Close Excel
Ctrl + Z	Undo
Ctrl + Y	Redo / Repeat
Ctrl + C	Copy
Ctrl + X	Cut
Ctrl + V	Paste
Ctrl + Alt + V	Paste Special
Delete	Clear cell contents
Esc	Cancel current action / edit
Ctrl + F	Find
Ctrl + H	Find and Replace
Ctrl + K	Insert hyperlink
Ctrl + A	Select current data region / all
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save As in some Excel versions / Windows conventions

2. Navigation & Selection

Shortcut	Action
Arrow Keys	Move one cell
Ctrl + Arrow	Jump to edge of current data region
Home	Go to beginning of row
Ctrl + Home	Go to cell A1
Ctrl + End	Go to last used cell
Page Up / Page Down	Move one screen up/down
Alt + Page Up / Page Down	Move one screen left/right
Ctrl + Page Up	Previous worksheet
Ctrl + Page Down	Next worksheet
Shift + Arrow	Extend selection by one cell
Ctrl + Shift + Arrow	Extend selection to edge of data region
Shift + Space	Select entire row
Ctrl + Space	Select entire column

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + Space	Select current region / all cells
F5	Go To dialog
Ctrl + G	Go To dialog
Ctrl + Backspace	Scroll active cell into view
Alt + ;	Select visible cells only

3. Data Entry & Editing

Shortcut	Action
F2	Edit active cell
Alt + Enter	Insert line break inside a cell
Ctrl + Enter	Fill selected cells with current entry
Ctrl + D	Fill Down
Ctrl + R	Fill Right
Ctrl + '	Copy formula from cell above
Ctrl + Shift + "	Copy value from cell above
Ctrl + ;	Enter current date
Ctrl + Shift + ;	Enter current time
Ctrl + Enter	Enter same value/formula into all selected cells
Enter	Complete entry and move down
Shift + Enter	Complete entry and move up
Tab	Complete entry and move right
Shift + Tab	Complete entry and move left
Ctrl + E	Flash Fill
Ctrl + Shift + Enter	Legacy array formula entry in older Excel versions

4. Formatting

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + 1	Format Cells dialog
Ctrl + B	Bold
Ctrl + I	Italic
Ctrl + U	Underline
Ctrl + 5	Strikethrough
Ctrl + Shift + ~	General format
Ctrl + Shift + \$	Currency format
Ctrl + Shift + %	Percentage format
Ctrl + Shift + ^	Scientific format
Ctrl + Shift + #	Date format

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + @	Time format
Ctrl + Shift + !	Number format with separators
Ctrl + Shift + &	Apply outline border
Ctrl + Shift + _	Remove outline border
Alt + H, O, I	AutoFit column width
Alt + H, O, A	AutoFit row height
Alt + H, H	Fill Color menu
Alt + H, FC	Font Color menu (version-dependent key tips)
Alt + H, B	Borders menu

5. Rows, Columns & Cells

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + +	Insert cells/rows/columns
Ctrl + -	Delete cells/rows/columns
Ctrl + 9	Hide selected rows
Ctrl + Shift + 9	Unhide rows
Ctrl + 0	Hide selected columns
Ctrl + Shift + 0	Unhide columns (may be blocked by Windows settings)
Shift + Space	Select row
Ctrl + Space	Select column
Alt + H, O, R	Rename selected sheet
Alt + H, O, W	Column Width dialog
Alt + H, O, H	Row Height dialog

6. Worksheets & Workbooks

Shortcut	Action
Shift + F11	Insert new worksheet
Alt + Shift + F1	Insert new worksheet
Ctrl + Page Up	Move to previous sheet
Ctrl + Page Down	Move to next sheet
Alt + O, H, R	Rename sheet in older menu-key sequences
Alt + E, L	Delete sheet in older Excel menu-key sequences
Ctrl + Shift + Page Up	Select current and previous worksheet(s)
Ctrl + Shift + Page Down	Select current and next worksheet(s)

7. Formulas & Calculation

Shortcut	Action
=	Start a formula
F4	Toggle absolute/relative references while editing a formula
Shift + F3	Insert Function dialog
Ctrl + `	Show/hide formulas
F9	Calculate all open workbooks
Shift + F9	Calculate active worksheet
Ctrl + Alt + F9	Force full calculation
Ctrl + Alt + Shift + F9	Rebuild dependencies and calculate
Alt + =	AutoSum
F4	Repeat last action; inside formula, cycle reference types
Ctrl + Shift + U	Expand/collapse formula bar
Ctrl + [	Select cells referenced directly by a formula
Ctrl +]	Select formulas that directly reference active cell

8. Tables, Filters & Data

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + T	Create Table
Ctrl + Shift + L	Toggle AutoFilter
Alt + Down Arrow	Open filter/drop-down list
Ctrl + Alt + L	Reapply filter in some Excel versions
Alt + A, S, S	Sort
Alt + A, S, A	Sort ascending in Ribbon key-tip sequence
Alt + A, S, D	Sort descending in Ribbon key-tip sequence
Alt + A, Q	Quick Analysis in supported versions / contexts
Ctrl + E	Flash Fill
Alt + A, M	Remove Duplicates
Alt + A, E	Text to Columns in many Ribbon versions

9. PivotTables & Analysis

Shortcut	Action
Alt + N, V	Insert PivotTable
Alt + J, T	PivotTable contextual tools in supported versions
Alt + F5	Refresh PivotTable / selected external data
Ctrl + Alt + F5	Refresh all
Shift + F10	Open context menu
Alt + F1	Create embedded chart from selected data
F11	Create chart on a new chart sheet

10. Charts & Objects

Shortcut	Action
Alt + F1	Create embedded chart
F11	Create chart sheet
Ctrl + 1	Format selected chart/object
Ctrl + Shift + G	Group selected objects
Ctrl + Shift + U	Ungroup selected objects in supported contexts
Arrow Keys	Move selected object
Ctrl + Arrow	Move object in smaller increments in supported contexts

11. Comments, Notes & Review

Shortcut	Action
Shift + F2	Insert/edit Note
Ctrl + Alt + M	Insert Comment in supported modern Excel versions
Ctrl + Shift + M	Open threaded comments pane in some versions
Shift + F10	Context menu

12. View, Freeze & Display

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + F1	Show/hide Ribbon
Alt + W, F, F	Freeze Panes menu sequence in many versions
Alt + W, F, R	Freeze Top Row in many versions
Alt + W, F, C	Freeze First Column in many versions
Ctrl + Mouse Wheel	Zoom in/out
Alt + W, Q	Zoom dialog
Ctrl + Shift + U	Expand/collapse formula bar
Ctrl + `	Show/hide formulas

13. Print & Page Layout

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + P	Open Print
Ctrl + F2	Print Preview
Alt + P, R	Print Area menu / Ribbon sequence varies by version
Alt + P, S, P	Page Setup dialog in many versions
Alt + P, M	Margins menu

Shortcut	Action
Alt + P, O	Orientation menu
Alt + P, S	Size menu

14. Selection Tricks & Power Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + A twice	Select entire worksheet from within a data region
Ctrl + Shift + +	Insert cells/rows/columns
Ctrl + Shift + -	Delete cells/rows/columns
Ctrl + Shift + 8	Show/hide outline symbols in some contexts
Ctrl + Shift + 7	Apply outline border in some keyboard layouts
Ctrl + Shift + 6	Show/hide objects
Ctrl + Shift + 9	Unhide rows
Ctrl + Shift + 0	Unhide columns where supported
Alt + ;	Select visible cells only
Ctrl + Shift + End	Extend selection to last used cell
Ctrl + Shift + Home	Extend selection to A1

15. Ribbon & Key Tips

Shortcut	Action
Alt	Show Ribbon Key Tips
Alt + F	File tab
Alt + H	Home tab
Alt + N	Insert tab
Alt + P	Page Layout tab
Alt + M	Formulas tab
Alt + A	Data tab
Alt + R	Review tab
Alt + W	View tab
Alt + Q	Search / Tell Me
Alt + Enter	Line break in cell; behavior depends on context

16. Function & Formula Quick Entry

Shortcut	Action
Alt + =	Insert SUM formula
Shift + F3	Insert Function
Ctrl + Shift + A	Insert function arguments after function name in older Excel workflows

Shortcut	Action
F9	Evaluate selected formula part while editing
Ctrl + Shift + U	Expand/collapse formula bar
Ctrl + `	Toggle formula view

17. Windows & Multiple Workbooks

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + F6	Switch between Excel windows
Ctrl + Shift + F6	Switch to previous Excel window
Ctrl + Tab	Switch to next open workbook/window in some Excel environments
Ctrl + W	Close active workbook
Alt + Tab	Switch between Windows applications

18. Accessibility & Help

Shortcut	Action
F1	Excel Help
Alt + Q	Search commands
Shift + F10	Context menu
Alt + Shift + F10	Display error-checking options when available

Important Notes & Shortcut Strategy

- This guide is focused on Microsoft Excel for Windows desktop. Some shortcuts vary by Excel version, keyboard layout, operating system settings, and whether a cell, table, chart, PivotTable, or dialog is active.
- Ribbon sequences such as Alt + H, O, I are Key Tip sequences: press the keys in order rather than holding them simultaneously.
- On some laptops, function keys require Fn. If a shortcut does not work, check whether your keyboard has Fn-lock enabled.
- Mac Excel uses many different shortcuts. This PDF intentionally focuses on Windows Excel.

Recommended Learning Order

Level	Focus
Level 1	Ctrl+C / X / V, Ctrl+Z / Y, Ctrl+S, Ctrl+F, Ctrl+H, Ctrl+Arrow, Ctrl+Home, Ctrl+End
Level 2	F2, Ctrl+1, Ctrl+Shift+L, Ctrl+T, Alt+=, Ctrl+D, Ctrl+R, Ctrl+E
Level 3	F4, Ctrl+Shift+Arrow, Alt+;, Ctrl+`, F5, Shift+F3, PivotTable and chart shortcuts
Level 4	Ribbon Key Tips, advanced selection, calculation, data cleaning and productivity workflows

Reference scope: This is a professional quick-reference handbook, not a guarantee that every shortcut works identically in every Excel release. Microsoft periodically changes Ribbon commands and contextual shortcuts.